Data Dictionary – Events

Task 1

Group 20

1. Overview

The events file provides a chronology of major economic, political, social and infrastructure events for 15 countries and the European Union aggregate, from 1900 to 2025.

Item	Value
Source file	`historical_events.csv`
Staging table	`aid_staging.stg_events`
Key	`event_id` (surrogate key generated on load; the file has no natural key)
Row count	387 events (388 lines in the file, including the header)
Number of entities	16 (15 countries and the EU aggregate, `EUU`)
Year span	1900–2025 (110 distinct years)

2. Columns

Column	Type	Description	Example
`event_id`	INT	Surrogate key	21
`year`	SMALLINT	Year of the event	1945
`country_iso3`	CHAR(3)	ISO 3166-1 alpha-3 country code	`PRT`
`country_name`	VARCHAR(100)	Country name (English)	Portugal
`event`	VARCHAR(500)	Description of the event	First motorway segment; ...
`category`	VARCHAR(50)	Type of event	Infrastructure
`economic_impact`	VARCHAR(100)	Economic impact of the event	Road modernization

3. Categories and Impacts

Category	Events
Political	102
Economy	90
Integration	40
War	39
Financial	32
Infrastructure	31
Industry	20
Geopolitical	13
Social	10
Colonial	5
Composite: War/Health, War/Industry, Integration/Industry, Infrastructure/Economy, Integration/Security	1 each
Total	**387**

Most frequent economic impacts

Economic Impact	Events
Pandemic shock	15
Monetary union	12
Regime change	11
European integration	8
State creation	7
Recession, GDP decline, Authoritarian rule, Repression	6 each

`economic_impact` is free text with 212 distinct values for 387 events, most labels appear only 1 to 3 times.

4. Temporal and Geographic Coverage

Coverage is described **by country and by decade**, because the number of events depends mainly on the country (Portugal is the focus country) and on the historical period.

Events by country

ISO3	Country	Years	Events
PRT	Portugal	1900–2025	125
ESP	Spain	1900–2020	19
FRA	France	1900–2020	19
DEU	Germany	1900–2020	22
BEL	Belgium	1900–2020	15
ITA	Italy	1900–2020	17
IRL	Ireland	1900–2020	17
GRC	Greece	1900–2020	19
POL	Poland	1900–2020	21
CZE	Czechia	1918–2020	17
HUN	Hungary	1900–2020	16
ROU	Romania	1900–2020	18
EST	Estonia	1900–2020	21
LVA	Latvia	1900–2020	19
LTU	Lithuania	1900–2020	17
EUU	European Union	1957–2007	5

Events by decade

Decade	All Countries	Portugal
1900s	16	3
1910s	26	5
1920s	28	4
1930s	20	4
1940s	47	7
1950s	28	12
1960s	28	17
1970s	32	18
1980s	26	8
1990s	51	16
2000s	40	14
2010s	25	11
2020s	20	6

Summary

- Portugal has 125 events; the other countries have between 15 and 22, and the EU aggregate has 5 (1957–2007).
- Most countries are covered from 1900 to 2020; Czechia starts in 1918 and only Portugal reaches 2025.
- Events are most frequent in the 1940s (World War II) and in the 1990s (post-communist transition and European integration). For Portugal, the peaks are the 1960s and 1970s.

5. Particularities and Data Quality

- **Unprotected comma in one row.** Row 362 (Ireland, 1990) has a comma inside the `event` text, and the file does not use quotes. It is handled in the load pipeline with a regular expression (only the `event` field may contain commas); the file is not modified and no row is rejected.
- **No natural key.** No short combination of columns identifies an event, so a surrogate key (`event_id`) is generated on load.
- **Several events in the same country and year.** This happens in 24 country-years, all in Portugal (up to 5 events in 1961, and 4 in 1973, 1975 and 1991). Events therefore cannot be stored as a single attribute of a country-year row.
- **Composite categories.** Five categories combine two types (War/Health, War/Industry, Integration/Industry, Infrastructure/Economy, Integration/Security).
- **No missing fields and no duplicates.** All events have a year, country, description, category and impact, and no event is repeated.
- **Coverage beyond the indicators.** Events go up to 2025, while Maddison ends in 2022, so the most recent events have no Maddison data.